

JAMES MITCHELL

Oxford, United Kingdom

james.mitchell@gmail.com

+44 7891 234567

linkedin.com/in/jamesmitchell1992

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 12 years of experience building scalable systems and leading technical initiatives at early-stage startups and established tech companies. I've spent the last five years focused on microservices architecture and database optimization, helping teams move from monolithic systems to distributed infrastructure. I enjoy mentoring junior developers and tend to get deeply involved in code reviews and system design decisions rather than staying in an ivory tower.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Backend Engineer

Velox Systems

veloxsystems.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led the redesign of our payment processing infrastructure, reducing transaction latency by 45 percent and improving system reliability to 99.99 percent uptime across 15 microservices.

Managed a team of four backend engineers and two junior developers, conducting weekly architecture reviews and establishing coding standards that reduced production incidents by 60 percent.

Implemented a comprehensive observability strategy using Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK stack, enabling the team to identify performance bottlenecks in real time rather than waiting for customer complaints.

Mentored three engineers who were promoted to senior roles within the organization by creating personalized learning plans and regularly pairing on complex system design problems.

Senior Backend Engineer

DataStream Solutions

datastream.co

Reading, United Kingdom

June 2018 - February 2022

Architected a distributed event streaming platform processing 2 million messages per second using Kafka and Go, replacing our legacy batch processing system and enabling real-time analytics for 50 enterprise clients.

Reduced database query times by 70 percent through strategic indexing, query optimization, and migration of hot data to Redis caching layer, improving customer dashboard load times from 8 seconds to under 1 second.

Owned the migration of authentication infrastructure from basic token systems to OAuth 2.0 with JWT implementation, eliminating 12 security vulnerabilities identified in external audit.

Established a chaos engineering practice to test system resilience, uncovering and preventing three major outage scenarios before they could affect production environments.

Backend Engineer

Touchstone Digital

touchstone.net

Oxford, United Kingdom

January 2012 - May 2018

Built RESTful APIs and backend services for a SaaS platform serving 200,000 users, working primarily with Python, PostgreSQL, and AWS infrastructure across EC2 and RDS.

Implemented automated testing framework increasing code coverage from 35 percent to 82 percent within 18 months, significantly reducing regression bugs and enabling faster deployments.

Designed and deployed database replication and failover systems that eliminated single points of failure and enabled zero-downtime deployments during critical business periods.

Collaborated with DevOps team to containerize legacy applications using Docker, reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes and improving consistency across development, staging, and production environments.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2011

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, Bash

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra

Messaging and Streaming: Kafka, RabbitMQ, Apache Pulsar

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, DynamoDB), Google Cloud Platform

Containerization and Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Swarm

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, New Relic

API Design: REST, gRPC, GraphQL

Version Control: Git, GitLab, Bitbucket

Caching: Redis, Memcached

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, CircleCI